

DELETE LINKEDIN

Backup your data

1. Login to Facebook desktop and enter 'Settings'
2. Click on the 'Me' tab
3. Go to the 'Account' option
4. Click on 'Settings and privacy'
5. Under 'Basics', click on 'Getting an archive of your data'
6. Select the '24 hour' option
7. You will get a link to the download in your email once your archive is ready

Delete your account

1. Click on the 'Me' tab
2. Select 'Settings and Privacy'
3. Click on 'Closing your LinkedIn account'
4. If you have a premium account, you will be prompted to cancel the membership
5. Provide a reason and click on 'Next'
6. Feed in your password and click on 'Close my account'

all be toggled off. In the same section, there is a tab that says 'Your Categories', which is the most relevant aspect to this whole issue. Simply delete the entries that you have no interest in, or the ones that you do not want to be used for targeting you. This list is also auto populated, and cannot be rendered permanently blank.

Finally you have 'Ad settings'. There are three categories here. Ads from Facebook partners use the data gathered from partner website, and includes online and offline information as well. This can be say, an e-commerce site that you make purchases from. The second category is the Facebook Audience Networks, which uses Facebook technology to deliver ads

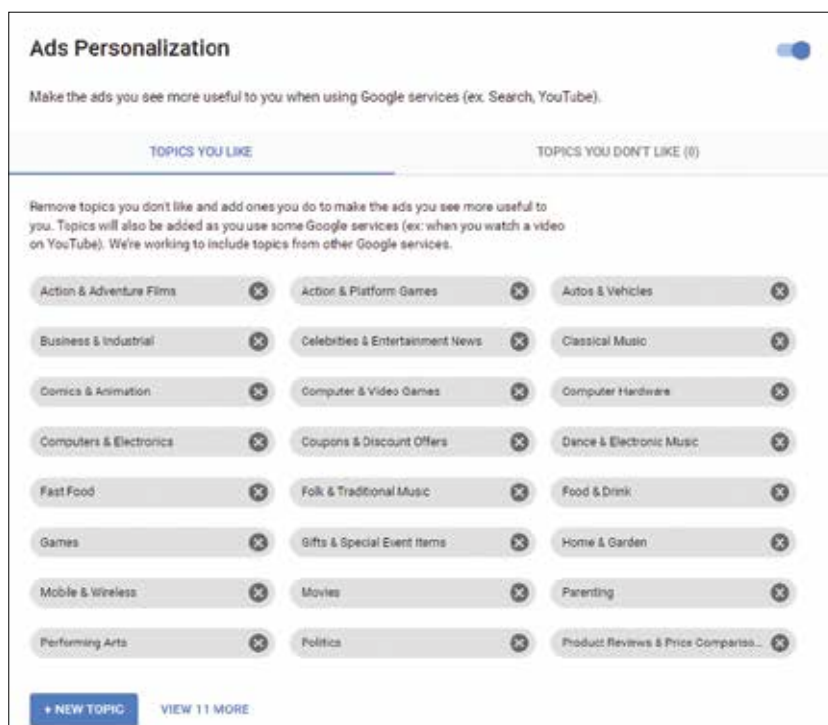
DELETE SNAPCHAT

Backup your data

1. Click on 'Settings' then 'Memories'
2. Select 'Save to' then 'Memories and Camera Roll'

Delete your account

1. Go to digit.in/delsnap
2. Login to your account
3. Click on 'Delete my account'
4. You have 30 days to reactivate your account



The Ads Personalisation settings for your Google account

over third party websites and applications. Finally, there are actually ads based on your actions. Some entities can pay Facebook to push out an ad on the timelines of your friends, when you like a page or share a post. You can choose to individually disable ads based on partners, through the Facebook Audience Network, or ads based on your social actions. You will continue to see the ads, they just will not be particularly targeted towards you. All you need to do is head over to Facebook Ad Preferences (digit.in/fbads) to make all these changes.

Google actually gives you even more control over the ads that you see. These are delivered to you on a wide range of platforms, services, websites and applications. At the bottom of the Google Ad Preferences page, there is an option to opt out of personalisation. Taking this step will mean that you will continue to see ads on the partnered web pages, but these ads will not be personalised. In the same page, you can also anonymise your personal information. Google just uses your Age and Gender for this profile, and you can set both to 'Unknown'. Most importantly, there is the 'Ads Personalisation' segment. The 'Topics you like' tab is similar to the 'Your Cat-

egories' tag in Facebook. Although the list is autopopulated, you can choose to feed in the categories that you want to see ads about. We wish that Facebook would provide the same option.

There is also a 'Topics you don't like' section. The easiest way to troll Google is take all the tags from the 'Topics you like' section and feed it into the 'Topics you don't like' section. To do this, all you need to do is cancel the topics from the 'Topics you like' section, and it automatically goes into the 'Topics you don't like' section. Deleting from the latter just removes the topic completely, and does not move it back to the former.

While it is possible to throw off the psychographic profiling tools, in the end it requires significantly more effort, and a different approach to social media. Deleting your social media accounts might seem like a good option, but you may need to start all over again in the future, for either professional or personal reasons. These platforms are here to stay. Content is going to get more personalised and more targeted. Hopefully, by learning about how these tools actually work, and exactly what it is used for, you are immune to all the scaremongering around this "data breach". **4**